



Some MSS. give an *appoggiatura* in bar 2 to match that in bar 40. Now, this is a typically suspicious case; for uniformitarian interpolaters seldom recognize parallel passages except in the top voice (which is one reason why Beethoven's form is supposed to be irregular in his last works); and, accordingly, no MSS. suggest the *appoggiatura* in bars 8 and 34. It has excellent sense as a new variation in bar 40, and there is no necessity for it to appear before.

The *tempo* is an *Andante* in which the nine quavers are not too slow for the swing of the three main beats, and not too fast for the details and ornaments. If, as recommended, the ornaments are omitted in practice until the main lines have been thoroughly mastered, they will be found quite easy to play with natural and delicate expression in a *tempo* that does not drag.

FUGUE IV

THE Subject is given out in a three-part Exposition (bars 1-6) followed by a straightforward development of its second bar in an Episode, leading to a complete Counterexposition (bars 16-22), of which the last entry is in E major. Soon there follows an Exposition of the Inverted Subject in all three voices (bars 24-29) immediately capped by an entry of the Direct Subject in the tonic.

After a few bars of Episode a Second Subject appears in longer notes, in the treble (bar 35), answered in Stretto by the middle voice and, in due course but in an unexpected key, by the bass. (Counterpoints not unlike this Subject have occurred before; the simple counterpoint of the Exposition has been a fairly regular Countersubject, and resembles this enough to cause confusion. All such resemblances must therefore be kept in the background; for the present new development soon proves to be of primary importance). An Episode follows, on the same lines as former Episodes, and is developed at some length. Suddenly, in bar 48, the Subject reappears in the treble combined with the Second Subject in the bass. This combination is in Double Counterpoint in the twelfth. A short Episode leads to an entry of the Inverted Subject (bars 53-54) which is immediately followed by the permutation of the Double Counterpoint in the twelfth (bars 55-56). The ensuing Episode brings the imitative treatment of the main figures into a climax of close texture. At bar 61 the combination of the two Subjects appears again, and at bar 66 it is inverted in the octave instead of the twelfth. A final answer to the First Subject then enters at the half-bar, and the Second Subject (in the middle voice) combines with it at a different point (bar 68). Hereupon the Fugue comes to an end.

The first Episode gave rise, in its last bars, to a new figure (bars 13½-14). This is developed in the subsequent Episodes (bars 33-34, 44-47, and 59-60), and must always be brought out very distinctly.

The lively style of the Fugue tempts the player to a dangerous *tempo*. A good way for the player to steady his nerve in this matter is to begin by taking the middle voice alone in bars 47-48, interpreting the *appoggiatura* as a group of two across the triple rhythm, thus:



and then practising it together with the other parts until it sounds graceful and singable. This accomplished, it should then not be brought into the foreground, but everything should be devoted to the spirited rendering of the two Subjects. Liveliness will come by rhythmic accentuation. Note particularly the abrupt ending without pause. Bach is always definite as to the length of his final chord.

A.B. 100.